B Minor

Scale Practice Worksheet · Two sharps (F♯, C♯) · Relative minor of D major · 4 octaves

SCALES

01 **Harmonic Minor**

Play B harmonic minor. The harmonic minor raises the 7th degree: A becomes A♯.

02 **Melodic Minor**

Play B melodic minor.

Ascending: raise the 6th and 7th degrees — G becomes G♯, A becomes A♯.

Descending: remove all alterations and descend as natural B minor.

03 **Scale in Thirds**

Play B minor in thirds — two notes a third apart, in succession. Move as evenly as possible. Avoid uneven notes especially in the left hand.

04 **Scale in Tenths**

Play the scale in tenths (octave + third between hands) using triplet rhythm. Practice both ascending and descending.

TIP
Play at a challenging tempo to expose what isn't working. When the pattern breaks down at speed, start again from the beginning — not from the middle.

05 **Scale in Sixths**

Play the scale in sixths using triplet rhythm. Apply accent patterns from the Variations section.

06 Short Arpeggios

Play B minor broken triads across 4 octaves. Work through root position, 1st inversion, and 2nd inversion.

TECHNIQUE
Feel the natural weight of the arm dropping into the keys. Move in circular motions — stay grounded and free, not rigid.

07 Long Arpeggios

Play B minor arpeggios across the full keyboard. In B minor, the left hand uses the 4th finger and the right hand uses the 3rd finger at key crossing points. Work through root position, 1st inversion, and 2nd inversion.

The thumb is the main source of difficulty — it tends to arrive late or land inaccurately. To isolate the problem:

Step 1 — Find the exact point where the thumb crossing is uneven.

Step 2 — Extract that small fragment.

Step 3 — Practice it slowly until the thumb lands correctly.

Step 4 — Return to the full arpeggio.

Pay particular attention to the ending of each inversion when returning from a black key — fingering differs between left and right hand.

TECHNIQUE
Separate hands first. Don't play both hands to cover what the left hand doesn't know. Practice in small segments to identify the exact problem.

SIX-CHORD ARPEGGIOS

08 Long Six-Chord Arpeggios

Extended arpeggios through a cycle of six chords in sequence. The roman numeral pattern is **I – i – VI – ♯vi – IV – iv**.

For B minor:

1) **B major — I** (tonic major, root position)

2) **B minor — i** (tonic minor, root position)

3) **G major — VI** (1st inversion)

4) **G♯ minor — ♯vi** (1st inversion)

5) **E major — IV** (2nd inversion)

6) **E minor — iv** (2nd inversion)

Play each chord as a long arpeggio across the keyboard before moving to the next.

FINISHING

09 Chromatic Scale

Play the chromatic scale starting from B across the full keyboard.

VARIATIONS

Contrary Motion

Any scale or arpeggio exercise can be played in contrary motion — one hand ascending while the other descends simultaneously. This is harder than parallel motion and excellent brain training.

ADVANCED VARIATION

In contrary motion with the melodic minor, one hand plays the raised ascending form while the other simultaneously plays the natural descending form. Then reverse which hand plays which.

Accent & Rhythmic Variations

Apply to any scale or arpeggio exercise for fluidity and evenness:

a Accent every note — extra weight on each individual note.

b Accent every second note — grouped, rolling feel.

c Accent every fourth note — builds longer phrase shapes.

d Triplet groupings — organize in groups of three, accenting the first note of each group.

> **TIP**
> Apply the accent in both hands equally. The left hand easily becomes passive while the right hand carries the accent alone.

Staccato

Any scale exercise can be played staccato — lift from each key rather than connecting the notes. Treat it as a separate pass, not a replacement for legato practice.

GENERAL PRACTICE PRINCIPLES

- Play at a challenging tempo to find what isn't working, then slow down to fix it
- When a passage breaks down at speed, start again from the beginning — not from the middle
- Practice in small segments to identify the exact problem
- Sit forward with feet supported on the floor — legs should not hang; weight must be grounded and able to lean into the keyboard
- Don't stay in a comfort zone when practicing alone — push the tempo
- Don't play both hands to cover what the left hand doesn't know
- Apply accents in both hands — the left hand easily becomes passive